UNITED KINGDOM

Immigration & Visa Categories — A to Z Master Directory

Database structure: Category Code + Category Name → Subcategory / Route Code + Route Name. Each route includes a short scope note for directory classification.

Important coding note: The codes in this catalogue (for example UKW-SWK or UKS-STU) are proposed internal database identifiers for your website. They are **not official UKVI visa subclass numbers**. The UK generally names immigration routes and categories rather than assigning one universal subclass-number system.

Scope and accuracy note: This directory covers the principal current routes, related immigration permissions and notable legacy/closed routes. It is not a claim that every administrative application, endorsement, exemption, document or immigration procedure is a separate visa. Route availability and eligibility can change; verify each record against current GOV.UK Immigration Rules before publishing.

UKV — Visit & Tourism

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKV-STD	Standard Visitor Visa	Tourism, family visits, permitted business activities, short study and medical visits
UKV-LTV	Long-term Standard Visitor Visa	2, 5 or 10-year validity; each visit normally limited to 6 months
UKV-MED	Private Medical Treatment Visitor	Private medical treatment in the UK
UKV-ACA	Academic Visitor	Permitted academic activities under visitor rules
UKV-PLS	Permitted Paid Engagement Visitor	Eligible paid engagement; normally within visitor framework
UKV-MAR	Marriage Visitor Visa	Marry or register civil partnership in the UK without settling
UKV-CHV	Child Visitor	Child visiting the UK
UKV-GRP	Visit for a permitted group activity	School, tour and other permitted group visits under visitor rules

UKT — Transit

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKT-AIR	Direct Airside Transit Visa (DATV)	Transit through the international area of a UK airport
UKT-VIS	Visitor in Transit Visa	Pass through UK border control to continue a journey
UKT-EXM	Transit without visa / transit exemptions	Limited exemption arrangements; eligibility depends on nationality and circumstances

UKW — Sponsored Work

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKW-SWK	Skilled Worker Visa	Eligible sponsored job with an approved UK employer
UKW-HCW	Health and Care Worker Visa	Eligible health or adult social care roles; subject to current occupation and sponsor rules
UKW-GBM-SSW	Global Business Mobility – Senior or Specialist Worker	Transfer to UK branch/group company in an eligible senior or specialist role
UKW-GBM-GT	Global Business Mobility – Graduate Trainee	Overseas graduate trainee placement in a UK linked business
UKW-GBM-UEW	Global Business Mobility – UK Expansion Worker	Establish a UK presence for an overseas business not yet trading in the UK
UKW-GBM-SS	Global Business Mobility – Service Supplier	Temporary provision of services under an eligible trade agreement or contract
UKW-GBM-SW	Global Business Mobility – Secondment Worker	High-value contract or investment-related secondment
UKW-SCU	Scale-up Worker Visa	Sponsored job with an eligible fast-growing UK business; later work flexibility

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKW-ISP	International Sportsperson Visa	Elite sportspeople and qualified coaches endorsed by the relevant governing body
UKW-T2M	T2 Minister of Religion	Minister of religion undertaking eligible long-term religious work

UKTW — Temporary Work

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKTW-SEA	Seasonal Worker Visa	Eligible horticulture or poultry seasonal work
UKTW-CHA	Charity Worker Visa	Unpaid voluntary work for an eligible charitable organisation
UKTW-CRE	Creative Worker Visa	Temporary work in the creative industries
UKTW-GAE	Government Authorised Exchange Visa	Approved work experience, training, research or fellowship scheme
UKTW-REL	Religious Worker Visa	Temporary non-pastoral religious work
UKTW-IAW	International Agreement Worker Visa	Work covered by international law or agreement

UKWO — Other Work & Talent Routes

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKWO-GT	Global Talent Visa	Recognised leaders or potential leaders in academia, research, arts and culture, or digital technology
UKWO-HPI	High Potential Individual (HPI) Visa	Eligible recent graduate of a qualifying top global university
UKWO-GRAD	Graduate Visa	Eligible graduates who completed a qualifying UK course
UKWO-YMS	Youth Mobility Scheme Visa	Eligible young nationals under participating country arrangements
UKWO-IYPS	India Young Professionals Scheme Visa	Indian citizens selected through the ballot and meeting scheme conditions
UKWO-ANC	UK Ancestry Visa	Eligible Commonwealth citizens with a qualifying UK-born grandparent
UKWO-ODW	Overseas Domestic Worker Visa	Eligible domestic workers accompanying an employer on a UK visit
UKWO-REP	Representative of an Overseas Business	Legacy route; closed to new applicants, subject to transitional provisions
UKWO-PRT	Private Servant in a Diplomatic Household	Private servants accompanying eligible diplomatic employers; route/rules are restricted

UKB — Business & Founder

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKB-IF	Innovator Founder Visa	Establish an innovative, viable and scalable business with endorsement
UKB-START	Start-up Visa	Closed to new applicants; historic route
UKB-INNOV	Innovator Visa	Closed/replaced by Innovator Founder; historic route
UKB-T1E	Tier 1 Entrepreneur	Closed route; historic cases only
UKB-T1I	Tier 1 Investor	Closed route; historic cases only
UKB-T1GE	Tier 1 Graduate Entrepreneur	Closed route; historic cases only

UKS — Study & Education

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKS-STU	Student Visa	Eligible adult student sponsored by a licensed education provider
UKS-CHS	Child Student Visa	Children aged 4–17 studying at an independent school
UKS-PCH	Parent of a Child Student Visa	One parent accompanying a child aged 4–11 studying at an independent school
UKS-SST	Short-term Study Visa (English language)	English language course lasting more than 6 months and up to 11 months

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKS-STD	Standard Visitor – short study	Permitted short study up to 6 months under visitor rules
UKS-TIER4	Tier 4 Student	Legacy student route; replaced by Student/Child Student routes

UKF — Family & Dependants

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKF-PART	Family visa – partner or spouse	Partner/spouse of a British or settled person, or qualifying sponsor
UKF-FIANCE	Family visa – fiancé(e) or proposed civil partner	Entry to marry or form a civil partnership, then apply to extend where eligible
UKF-CHILD	Family visa – child	Child joining or staying with a qualifying parent
UKF-PARENT	Family visa – parent	Parent of a child in the UK, subject to detailed eligibility rules
UKF-ADULT	Family visa – adult dependent relative	Long-term care need where required care is unavailable/affordable overseas
UKF-DEPEND	Dependant partner / child on a work or study route	Dependants of eligible main applicants; route-specific restrictions apply
UKF-PRIVATE	Private Life route	Permission/settlement based on private life in the UK
UKF-SETL	Family route settlement (ILR)	Settlement after meeting the applicable family route requirements

UKEU — EU, EEA & Swiss Routes

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKEU-EUSS	EU Settlement Scheme – settled status	Indefinite permission for eligible EEA/Swiss citizens and family members
UKEU-PRE	EU Settlement Scheme – pre-settled status	Limited permission for eligible applicants not yet qualifying for settled status
UKEU-FP	EU Settlement Scheme Family Permit	Eligible family member joining/accompanying an EUSS qualifying person
UKEU-FW	Frontier Worker Permit	Eligible EU/EEA/Swiss citizens working in the UK while resident elsewhere
UKEU-SUR	Surinder Singh / retained rights cases	Legacy/transitional family rights cases where applicable

UKH — Hong Kong BN(O) & Ukraine

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKH-BNO	Hong Kong British National (Overseas) Visa	Eligible BN(O) status holders and qualifying family members
UKH-UEP	Ukraine Permission Extension Scheme	Eligible people previously granted permission under Ukraine schemes
UKH-HF	Homes for Ukraine Sponsorship Scheme	Permission under the Ukraine humanitarian sponsorship route
UKH-UFS	Ukraine Family Scheme	Closed to new applications; historic permission and extension matters
UKH-UKR	Ukraine Extension / transitional permission cases	Applicable legacy Ukraine scheme provisions

UKC — Commonwealth & Ancestry

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKC-ANC	UK Ancestry Visa	Commonwealth citizen with qualifying UK-born grandparent
UKC-BNO	British National (Overseas) Visa	BN(O) route for eligible Hong Kong applicants
UKC-RIGHT	Right of Abode	Status allowing a person to live and work in the UK without immigration restrictions
UKC-ROA-CTR	Certificate of Entitlement to Right of Abode	Evidence of an existing right of abode

UKP — Protection & Humanitarian

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKP-ASY	Asylum claim	Claim for international protection in the UK
UKP-REF	Refugee permission / refugee status	Protection granted following a successful asylum claim
UKP-HUM	Humanitarian Protection	Permission granted where humanitarian protection criteria are met
UKP-DLR	Discretionary Leave	Exceptional/limited leave outside standard routes
UKP-HP	Human Rights claim	Claim based on human rights grounds, including family/private life
UKP-AR	Asylum/protection appeal and further submissions	Procedural protection-related applications, not a standalone entry visa
UKP-RESET	Resettlement routes	Government-supported refugee resettlement schemes, subject to programme availability

UKR — Settlement & Long Residence

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKR-ILR	Indefinite Leave to Remain (ILR)	Settlement after qualifying work, family, protection or other route
UKR-LR	Long Residence ILR	Settlement based on qualifying continuous lawful residence
UKR-SETL	Settlement on work route	ILR under eligible Skilled Worker, Global Talent, Innovator Founder and other routes
UKR-FAM	Settlement on family route	ILR under applicable partner, parent or child route
UKR-PRIVATE	Settlement on Private Life route	Settlement where private-life requirements are met
UKR-RETURN	Returning Resident Visa	For certain former settled residents returning to the UK
UKR-ROA	Right of Abode	Immigration status, not a visa; included for directory completeness

UKN — Nationality & Citizenship

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKN-NAT	British citizenship by naturalisation	Application by eligible adults
UKN-REG	British citizenship by registration	Registration for eligible adults or children
UKN-CHILD	Child citizenship / registration	Child-specific nationality registration routes
UKN-DESC	British citizenship by descent	Citizenship acquired through a qualifying British parent
UKN-REN	Renunciation / resumption of British nationality	Nationality status procedures, not visas
UKN-BOC	British Overseas Territories / other British nationality status	Nationality categories and registration routes

UKX — Entry Permission, Electronic Authorisation & Special Cases

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKX-ETA	Electronic Travel Authorisation (ETA)	Pre-travel authorisation for eligible non-visa nationals; not a visa
UKX-TRP	Temporary Worker / Temporary Permission extensions	In-country permission applications under relevant route rules
UKX-TRP2	Temporary Permission to Stay / Leave Outside the Rules	Exceptional permission; not a standard visa category
UKX-VIP	VIP Delegate Visa	Route for qualifying official delegates accompanying a Head of State or government minister
UKX-S2	S2 Healthcare Visitor	Eligible planned healthcare visitor under specific arrangements
UKX-EXM	Exempt persons / diplomatic and official status	Special immigration treatment; not an ordinary visa
UKX-ATAS	ATAS requirement	Academic Technology Approval Scheme clearance; not a visa

UKL — Legacy & Closed Immigration Routes

Subcategory / Visa Code	Visa / Route Name	Scope / Description
UKL-T1G	Tier 1 General	Closed
UKL-T1E	Tier 1 Entrepreneur	Closed
UKL-T1I	Tier 1 Investor	Closed
UKL-T1GE	Tier 1 Graduate Entrepreneur	Closed
UKL-T2G	Tier 2 General	Replaced by Skilled Worker
UKL-T2ICT	Tier 2 Intra-company Transfer	Replaced by Global Business Mobility routes
UKL-T2M	Tier 2 Minister of Religion	Legacy naming; current route is T2 Minister of Religion
UKL-T2S	Tier 2 Sportsperson	Replaced by International Sportsperson
UKL-T4	Tier 4 General Student	Replaced by Student route
UKL-T5	Tier 5 Temporary Worker	Replaced by current Temporary Work routes
UKL-ICT	Intra-company Transfer	Legacy route; current Global Business Mobility routes apply
UKL-SUR	Surinder Singh route	Legacy/transitional cases only
UKL-UKFAM	UK Family Permit (old EEA rules)	Legacy/transitional cases only
UKL-DV	Domestic Violence concession / settlement provisions	Historic and current protection/settlement provisions depend on facts

Official verification sources

• GOV.UK — Visas and immigration: https://www.gov.uk/browse/visas-immigration
• Work visas: https://www.gov.uk/browse/visas-immigration/work-visas
• Immigration Rules index: https://www.gov.uk/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-index
• Visitor rules: https://www.gov.uk/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-v-visitor
• Skilled Worker rules: https://www.gov.uk/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-skilled-worker
• Global Talent rules: https://www.gov.uk/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-global-talent
• Innovator Founder rules: https://www.gov.uk/guidance/immigration-rules/immigration-rules-appendix-innovator-founder